

Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

ServiceNow Micro Project Documentation

Phase 1: Ideation

Item	Details
Project Title	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
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Platform	ServiceNow
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1. Project Title

Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) in ServiceNow

2. Background

Organizations often receive bulk employee data from external sources such as HR teams, vendors, or legacy systems, usually as Excel or CSV files. Entering this data record by record in ServiceNow is slow, error-prone, and hard to scale. ServiceNow provides Import Sets and Transform Maps to automate bulk data migration. This project explores that capability through a practical employee data scenario.

3. Problem Statement

- Employee data arrives in spreadsheet format and must be loaded into ServiceNow.
- Manual entry causes typos, inconsistencies, and wasted effort.
- Re-importing the same file or a corrected version can create duplicate records.
- There is no built-in visibility into the imported data (distribution by department or location) without extra reporting.

4. Proposed Idea

Build an end-to-end, automated data import pipeline:

1. Prepare employee data in a spreadsheet (.xlsx).
2. Create a custom target table, Employee Test (u_employee_test).
3. Load the spreadsheet into a staging table (Import Set), Employee Import (u_employee_import).
4. Use a Transform Map to map staging fields to the target table fields.
5. Enable Coalesce on Employee ID so repeated imports update existing records instead of duplicating them.
6. Build Reports and a Dashboard for insight into the imported data.

5. Objectives

- Understand the full ServiceNow import flow: data loading, field mapping, transformation, and verification.
- Import 15 sample employee records accurately into a custom table.
- Prevent duplicates using Coalesce, and confirm that updates and inserts behave correctly on re-import.
- Visualize employee data through three reports (Department, Location, List) on a single dashboard.
- Give beginners a clear, repeatable learning reference.

6. Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope
Creating a custom table with 5 string fields	Complex data cleansing or scripted transforms
Spreadsheet import via Load Data	Scheduled or automated imports from data sources (JDBC, REST)
Transform Map with field mapping	Integration with the core sys_user table
Coalesce on Employee ID	Role-based access design beyond basic sharing
Reports (Pie, Bar, List) and a dashboard	Advanced Performance Analytics

7. Stakeholders and Target Users

Stakeholder	Interest
ServiceNow Administrator/Developer	Configures the table, import, and transform map
HR Team	Supplies employee data and consumes reports
Administrators/Managers	Monitor data quality and trends via the dashboard
Beginners/Learners	Use the project as a training reference

8. Sample Data Overview

- **Fields:** Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, Location
- **Volume:** 15 initial records, with later additions to test updates and inserts
- **Departments:** ServiceNow, Salesforce (later, AIML)
- **Locations:** Hyderabad (later, Chennai)

9. Alternatives Considered

Approach	Why not chosen
Manual record entry	Slow, error-prone, does not scale

Approach	Why not chosen
Import directly into an existing table	Less control and no staging area for validation
Scripted import (background script/REST)	Too advanced for a beginner-level project
Import Set + Transform Map (chosen)	Native, no-code, supports staging, mapping, coalesce, and logging

10. Tools and Technologies

- ServiceNow platform (Tables, Load Data, Import Sets, Transform Maps, Reports, Dashboards, ACLs)
- Google Sheets / Excel for source data (exported as .xlsx)

11. Expected Outcomes

- All source records are available in the Employee Test table with correct field values.
- Re-importing a corrected file updates existing records and inserts only new ones.
- Re-importing an unchanged file produces no duplicates (records ignored).
- A dashboard, Employee Analytics Dashboard, presents department distribution, location distribution, and a full employee list.

12. Assumptions, Risks and Mitigations

Type	Description	Mitigation
Assumption	User has admin access to a ServiceNow instance	Confirm access before starting
Assumption	Source file columns match the target fields	Standardize headers in the spreadsheet
Risk	Duplicate records on repeated imports	Enable Coalesce on Employee ID
Risk	Incorrect field mapping	Use Auto Map Matching and verify the field map list
Risk	Dashboard creation blocked by ACL	Enable Admin Overrides on the pa_dashboards create ACL
Risk	Inconsistent data (e.g., mixed-case values, name variations)	Validate source data before import

13. Success Criteria

- Import and transform both finish with State: Complete and Completion code: Success.
- The Employee Test table shows the expected record count (15 initially, 17 after the update import).
- Coalesce behavior is verified: 2 inserts and 2 updates on the modified file, and 0 inserts/0 updates on an identical re-import.

- All three reports render correctly and appear on the dashboard.